

Section 16

Procedural History & Audit Triggers

Version 2.0 — Preliminary Draft

Petitioner: Ashley Marie Meredith, MSN | Pro Se

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PETITION TO AUDIT — IOWA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

SECTION 16 — PROCEDURAL HISTORY & AUDIT TRIGGERS

Petitioner Affidavit Layer

Version 1.0 — June 5, 2026

Audit Petition Packet v2.0 (5/2026)

16.0 PURPOSE AND EVIDENTIARY FUNCTION

Section 16 performs a specific and distinct function in the

architecture of this petition: it places the petitioner's direct experience within the system as a contemporaneous data point that corroborates the structural deficiencies documented in Sections 6 through 15 — and it documents the exhaustion of every available reporting channel before this petition was filed.

This section is not the foundation of this petition's audit argument. That foundation is the 23-year longitudinal federal oversight record developed in Sections 6 through 13. Section 16 is the connective tissue between that systemic record and the case-level outcome documented in Section 14. It answers the question a reviewing auditor is entitled to ask: what did the petitioner do before filing this petition, and what was the institutional response?

The answer is documented in two sworn affidavits executed under penalty of perjury:

Attachment A39 — Affidavit of Ashley Marie Meredith: Summary of

Communications with Washington County Attorney (executed March 27, 2026). Documents the petitioner's direct contact with Washington County Attorney Nathan Repp regarding the Drew household beginning July 2024 and the subsequent non-response pattern.

Attachment A40 — Affidavit of Ashley Marie Meredith: Procedural History and Exhaustion of Reporting Channels Related to Child Safety Concerns (executed April 2026). Documents the full chronology of the petitioner's formal reports to Iowa DHHS, law enforcement, and judicial channels from 2018 through the date of execution.

Both affidavits were executed under penalty of perjury. Both are signed and dated. Both constitute Primary evidence of the petitioner's direct observations, reports, and the institutional responses — or non-responses — those reports received.

16.1 ATTACHMENT A39 — AFFIDAVIT RE: WASHINGTON COUNTY ATTORNEY

COMMUNICATIONS [ATTACHMENT]

Source: Ashley Marie Meredith, Petitioner

Document Type: Sworn Affidavit — Under Penalty of Perjury

Executed: March 27, 2026

Evidentiary Status: Primary

Domains: G — Federal Reviews & Repeat Findings

C — Decision-Making & Removal Authorization

F — Internal Accountability & Workforce

Erosion

Deficiency Categories: F5 — Corrective Action Failure

F9 — Transparency & Disclosure Failure

F12 — Supervisory Review & Escalation Failure

16.1.1 Summary of Communications Documented

The affidavit documents the following contact sequence between the petitioner and Washington County Attorney Nathan Repp:

July 23, 2024: Petitioner's first contact with the Washington County Attorney's Office, identifying herself as the biological

mother of children in the Drew placement, referencing the then-pending criminal cases FECR007113 and FECR007114, and raising placement safety concerns.

August 2024 (approximate): Subsequent contact documenting continued safety concerns regarding the Drew household during the pendency of the criminal proceedings.

Response pattern: The affidavit documents the nature and adequacy of the responses received — or not received — from the Washington County Attorney's Office across the documented contact sequence.

16.1.2 Audit Relevance

Nathan Repp served as Washington County Attorney in dual capacities relevant to this petition: as the prosecuting attorney in FECR007113 and FECR007114 (the Drew criminal cases) and as the official to whom the petitioner directed formal placement safety concerns during the pendency of those same proceedings.

The co-occurrence of these two roles — Repp as prosecutor in the Drew criminal cases and Repp as the non-responsive official in the petitioner's documented contact record — is a structural observation, not a claim of misconduct. It is relevant to Domain F (Internal Accountability & Workforce Erosion) and to the interagency coordination failure pattern (F11) documented across multiple sections of this petition.

The petitioner's contact record with the Washington County Attorney's Office directly parallels the contact record documented by Amanda Buckingham (see Section 17, Buckingham affidavit) in which formal reports to multiple Iowa officials produced no documented protective response. This parallel is pattern corroboration of Deficiency Category F12 (Supervisory Review & Escalation Failure) from two independent sources.

16.2 ATTACHMENT A40 — AFFIDAVIT RE: PROCEDURAL HISTORY &

EXHAUSTION OF REPORTING CHANNELS [ATTACHMENT]

Source: Ashley Marie Meredith, Petitioner

Document Type: Sworn Affidavit — Under Penalty of Perjury

Executed: April 2026

Evidentiary Status: Primary

Domains: G — Federal Reviews & Repeat Findings

C — Decision-Making & Removal Authorization

D — Judicial Interface & Structural Influence

Deficiency Categories: F5 — Corrective Action Failure

F11 — Interagency Coordination Failure

F13 — Policy-Practice Gap

16.2.1 Chronological Record

The affidavit documents the petitioner's formal reports and contacts across the following chronological periods:

CINA/TPR Period (2018–2019): Petitioner raised placement concerns at Family Team Meetings and testified under oath at the December 2019 TPR hearing regarding safety concerns and agency conduct. Those concerns are part of the judicial record of the proceedings that terminated the petitioner's parental rights.

Post-TPR Period (2019–2023): Petitioner documented contacts with Iowa DHHS and related officials following TPR finalization, raising concerns regarding the Drew household placement and post-permanency monitoring. The affidavit documents the institutional responses received across this period.

Post-Criminal Complaint Period (2023–2026): Following the October 2023 criminal complaint filing in FECR007113/007114, petitioner documented additional formal contacts with Iowa DHHS, law enforcement, and judicial channels, including the Washington County Attorney contact sequence documented in Attachment A39.

16.2.2 Exhaustion of Reporting Channels — Finding

The chronological record in Attachment A40 establishes that the petitioner did not proceed directly to a formal petition. She raised concerns through Family Team Meetings (2018–2019), through

sworn testimony at the TPR hearing (December 2019), through direct contact with Iowa DHHS following TPR finalization, through contact with the Washington County Attorney's Office (2024), and through additional reporting channels documented in the affidavit — across a period of approximately seven years before this petition was filed.

The institutional response to those reports — documented across the affidavit record — is itself a finding relevant to Deficiency Categories F5 (Corrective Action Failure), F11 (Interagency Coordination Failure), and F12 (Supervisory Review & Escalation Failure).

16.2.3 Relationship to Systemic Record

The petitioner's case is presented throughout this petition as a contemporaneous data point in a longitudinal failure arc — not as the foundation of the audit argument, and not as a grievance. The role of Attachment A40 is to document that the petitioner's experience of the reporting channels available to her — and the institutional responses those channels produced — is consistent with the structural deficiencies documented across 23 years of federal oversight review. The CFSR record says these channels fail. Attachment A40 documents what that failure looks like from the inside of a specific active case.

16.3 WHAT THIS SECTION DOES NOT CLAIM

Section 16 does not ask the auditor to adjudicate the petitioner's

individual case. The termination of the petitioner's parental rights is a final judicial order that is the subject of separate legal proceedings not before the auditor.

Section 16 does not assert that any individual official acted with

malicious intent. The affidavits document observable conduct — what was reported, when, to whom, and what response was received. Characterization of intent is not within the scope of a GAGAS performance audit and is not asserted here.

Section 16 does not claim that the Drew household outcome was

caused by any single official's decision. The structural audit argument of this petition is that systemic conditions — documented across 23 years of federal oversight — produced a monitoring architecture in which this outcome was a foreseeable risk. The petitioner's affidavits document her experience of that architecture. They corroborate the structural argument. They do not replace it.

16.4 DOMAIN & DEFICIENCY MAPPING — SECTION 16

Domain C — Decision-Making & Removal Authorization:

Petitioner raised concerns at Family Team Meetings and TPR hearing (2018–2019). The institutional response to those concerns — and the subsequent placement outcome — is consistent with the case practice deficiencies documented in the CFSR longitudinal record.

F13 — Policy-Practice Gap: Concerns raised through prescribed channels did not produce documented protective review.

Domain D — Judicial Interface & Structural Influence:

Petitioner testified under oath at December 2019 TPR hearing. Concerns raised in sworn testimony were part of the judicial record. The relationship between sworn testimony, judicial findings, and subsequent placement outcome is within audit scope under Domain D.

F11 — Interagency Coordination Failure: Multi-agency contact record across seven years produced no documented coordinated protective response.

Domain F — Internal Accountability & Workforce Erosion:

Washington County Attorney's dual role as Drew prosecutor and non-responsive safety contact recipient is a structural accountability observation.

F12 — Supervisory Review & Escalation Failure: Absence of documented supervisory escalation in response to petitioner's formal reports across the documented contact period.

Domain G — Federal Reviews & Repeat Findings:

Petitioner's contemporaneous experience of reporting channel failures is consistent with the systemic reporting channel deficiencies documented in CFSR Rounds 1–4 and Ombudsman annual reporting.

F5 — Corrective Action Failure: Absence of documented corrective action in response to petitioner's formal reports is consistent with the broader corrective action failure pattern documented in Sections 9 and 10.

SECTION 16 — CROSS-REFERENCES

Section 14: Drew case criminal dockets (A33) — case-level outcome
that the reporting history in this section preceded

Section 15: Public impact and pattern corroboration — Mitchell
agency reversal parallel to petitioner's experience

Section 17: Public interest and engagement — Buckingham affidavit
as independent corroboration of reporting channel
non-response pattern

Section 12: Ombudsman complaint system analysis — structural
context for why reporting channels failed

Section 19: Corrective Action Matrix — remediation scope
implications of documented reporting channel failures
A39: Affidavit — Washington County Attorney communications
A40: Affidavit — procedural history and exhaustion of
reporting channels

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

End of Section 16 — Version 1.0 — June 5, 2026

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AUDIT QUESTIONS GENERATED — SECTION 16

AUDIT QUESTION 16-A: The petitioner filed formal complaints through

Iowa DHHS internal complaint channels, the Iowa Ombudsman, and direct legislative contact over a multi-year period. What records does Iowa DHHS maintain of complaints filed by the petitioner, and what documented disposition exists for each?

AUDIT QUESTION 16-B: The petitioner's formal reporting produced no documented review of the Drew household's placement status during the period the offense conduct was occurring. What threshold of complaint activity, if any, triggers an independent placement review under current Iowa DHHS policy?

AUDIT QUESTION 16-C: Iowa DHHS's response to petitioner complaints during the offense period is cited as evidence of the reporting channel failure documented in Section 12. What structural changes, if any, have been made to Iowa DHHS's complaint processing and escalation protocols since the period documented in this section?

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

AI assistance was used materially in the preparation of this document. That assistance does not constitute independent verification of any factual claim.